SABRINA J. CURTIS, Ph.D.

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EDUCATION

2021 **Ph.D. Education**
The George Washington University, Washington, D.C.
Concentration: Education and Inequality

2012 **M.A. English**
Texas Southern University, Houston, Texas
Emphasis: African (Anglophone) and African American Literature

2008 **B.A. English / 2nd B.A. Political Science**
University of New Mexico, Albuquerque, New Mexico
Minor: Africana Studies

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Race, gender, class and their implications for the civic and political lives of Black women and girls. Sub-fields: Civic identity and sociopolitical development in Black girls; Black girlhood studies; critical methodologies, critical race feminism, Black feminism in education, community-based education, and culturally sustaining curriculum and pedagogy in out-of-school settings.

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

University of Virginia, Charlottesville, VA

2023-Present Assistant Professor of Education (General Faculty-Teaching), Youth and Social Innovation, School of Education and Human Development

The George Washington University, Washington, D.C.

2022-2023 Visiting Assistant Professor and Director of Graduate Studies, Women's, Gender, and Sexuality Studies

2021-2022 Adjunct Professor (0.5 FTE), International Education Program, Department of Educational Leadership, The Graduate School of Education

University of Maryland Global Campus, Largo, MD

2015-2020 Adjunct Assistant Professor, Writing Department (online instruction)

Howard University, Washington, D.C.

2013-2014 Lecturer, Department of English

SCHOLARSHIP

Publications

2025 **Curtis, S. J.,** & Evans-Winters, V. E. (2025). Research beyond the gaze: Black feminism and youth participatory action research as critical qualitative interventions. *International Journal of Qualitative Studies in Education*, 1–19. https://doi.org/10.1080/09518398.2025.2502071

2024 **Curtis, S.** (2024). Black Girl Politics: Curricular Interventions for Nurturing Black Girls' Political Consciousness. *Journal of African American Women and Girls in Education*, *3*(2), 119–138. https://doi.org/10.21423/jaawge-v3i1a155

2024 **Curtis, S.J.** Possessing a higher consciousness: Black Feminism and spirituality in critical civic inquiry. In V.E. Evans-Winters, A. Pabon, & T. Robinson (Eds.) *Black women mothering and daughtering during a dual pandemic: Writing our backs*. Information Age Press. (pp. 63-74).

2020 **Curtis, S. J.** (2020). Sisters, friends, and kin: Critical pedagogies and Black girl civics. In J. Mackey & G. Logan (Eds.). *Black Girl Civics: Expanding and Navigating the Boundaries of Civic Engagement*. Charlotte, NC: Information Age Press (pp. 55-69).

Manuscripts Under Review

Curtis, S.J. & Ali, A.I. Surveillance in Education: Implications for Research and Practice. In. D. C. Martinez and E. Montaño (Eds.) *Encyclopedia of Social Justice in Education*, Bloomsbury. (invited entry under review).

Manuscripts In Preparation

Curtis, S.J. Resisting Anti-CRT Antics: Fostering Black Girls' Critical Consciousness through Historically Responsive Literacy.

Dortch, D., **Curtis, S.J.**, & Powell, N.N. The hidden cost of admission: African American doctoral students experiencing isolation.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Curtis, S.J. (2025, April). Empowering youth through participatory action research for democracy and justice. [Invited Speaker Session]. American Educational Research Association Annual Meeting, Denver, CO.

Curtis, S.J. (2024, November). Possessing a higher consciousness: Restoring the spiritual center in civic praxis [Paper]. National Women's Studies Association, Detroit, MI.

Curtis, S.J. (2023, April). Civic engagement & the politicization of Black girls' praxis as a research imperative [Paper]. American Educational Research Association Annual Meeting, Philadelphia, PA.

Curtis, S.J. (2023, April). Fostering Black girls' critical consciousness through historically responsive literacy. [Paper]. American Educational Research Association Annual Meeting, Philadelphia, PA.

Curtis, S.J. (2023, March). They want to be white if that makes sense: Black girls navigating surveillance and body politics in schools. Critical Girlhood Studies Symposium, Virtual.

Curtis, S.J. (2022, November). Teaching to Transgress: Creating Pathways for Black Girl Freedom, Inquiry, and Belonging [Paper]. National Women's Studies Association Annual Conference, Minneapolis, MN.

Curtis, S.J. (2022, May). Possessing a higher consciousness: Centering the spiritual in critical civic inquiry [Paper]. International Congress of Qualitative Inquiry Annual Meeting, Virtual.

Curtis, S.J. (2022, April). Black Girls' Political Literacies: Multimodal Composition and Civic Practice [Symposium]. American Educational Research Association Annual Meeting, Virtual.

Curtis, S.J., Baines, J.R., & Evans-Winters, V.E. (2020, May). A Missing Piece: A Quest from Doubt to Daughtering [Paper]. International Congress of Qualitative Inquiry Annual Meeting, Urbana-Champaign, IL (Conference Canceled).

Curtis, S. J. (2020, Apr 17 - 21). But What About the Kids? Black Girls' Theorizing About Youth-Driven Civic Engagement [Symposium]. American Educational Research Association Annual Meeting San Francisco, CA http://tinyurl.com/tra3qad (Conference Canceled).

Curtis, S. J. (2020, Apr 17 - 21). "I Am Not Beneath You": Black Girls Truth-Telling in a Liberatory Counter-Space [Roundtable Session]. American Educational Research Association Annual Meeting San Francisco, CA http://tinyurl.com/rj84uwu (Conference Canceled).

Curtis, S.J. (2019, October). Reimagining curriculum in community education spaces: An autobiographical inquiry into Black feminist research and practice [Paper]. Bergamo Conference on Curriculum, Beavercreek, OH.

Jones, A. & **Curtis, S. J.** (2019, May). Bits and pieces of ourselves: Intersectional identity performance of Black doctoral students at a PWI. Critical Race Studies in Education Los Angeles, CA.

Curtis, S. J. & Jones, A. (2019, May). Utterances once unheard: Utilizing duoethnography to explore Black women Ph.D. students intersectional identity performance [Paper]. International Congress of Qualitative Inquiry Urbana-Champaign, IL.

Curtis, S. J. (2019, January). Cultural consciousness and critical pedagogies in Black girls' civic identity development [Paper]. National Council of Black Studies New Orleans, LA.

Sinclair, M., Chabbott, C., Williams, J. H., Jeong, J. and **Curtis, S. J. (**2018, April). Networking to integrate SDG Target 4.7 and SEL into educational materials [Pre-Conference Workshop Presentation]. Comparative and International Education Society Mexico City, MX.

Curtis, S. J. (2014, March 26 - 29). Dual notions of reality: Personal narratives by social activists of African Descent [Paper]. College Language Association Conference New Orleans, LA.

Curtis, S. J. (2011). Tradition, ritual, and spirituality: Colonization as infringement upon the boundaries of identity and purpose [Paper]. Rice University Center for the Study of Women, Gender, and Sexuality Graduate Symposium Houston, TX.

PRESENTATIONS & TALKS

Curtis, S.J. (2022, November). Critical approaches to education research: A conversation with adolescent girls in the U.S. and Zimbabwe (with Ellen Chigwanda). ITEP Global Education Forum, School of Education, American University.

Curtis, S.J. (2020, September). Global citizenship education and the crises of multiculturalism [Discussant]. International and Comparative Education Talks. Graduate School of Education and Human Development, The George Washington University Washington, DC.

CONTRACTS & CONSULTING

2024 **Tides Foundation Advancing Girls Fund (Youth Participatory Grantmaking – $55,000)**
Provide advisement on the development of a youth advisory council to support programmatic shift towards participatory grantmaking and development of related curricular materials for youth engagement work.

2023 **Justice for Youth Survivors Initiative (Strategic Planning – $10,000)**
Consult on funding, public engagement, and research strategies for launching initiative on juvenile justice for girls and gender-expansive youth.

2021 **Crittenton Services of Greater Washington (Policy Advising – $19,600)**
Consult on youth advocacy training and strategies for advancing organizational commitments to advocating for policies and practices that increase access and equity and improve educational outcomes for girls.

2020 **GrassROOTS Community Foundation (Curriculum Development – $7,000)**
Development and implementation of community focused online civic education courses.

2020 **The Nature Conservancy (Research – $30,000)**
Mixed methods study evaluation of environmental education curriculum. Co-PI w/Dr. Laura Engel and Dr. Hallie Fox).

GRADUATE RESEARCH ASSISTANT EXPERIENCE

2019-2021 Desk research and manuscript preparation related to doctoral socialization of Black doctoral students related to discrimination, microaggressions, and structural, intellectual, and self-imposed isolation (PI: Dr. Deniece Dortch)

2019 Data analysis/discourse analysis on university issued statements regarding the 2017 Executive Order banning entry into the United States from predominately Muslim countries (PI: Dr. Arshad Ali).

2018 Support development of grant applications for longitudinal study on the relationship between study abroad and racial identity development in secondary students in urban schools (PI: Dr. Laura Engel).

2017 Desk research and development of literature reviews on policies and practices for gender mainstreaming in textbooks and teaching social and emotional learning in high-, low-resourced, and post-conflict settings in support of the initial development of the NISSEM working group – Networking to Integrate SDG Target 4.7 and SEL skills into Educational Materials [nissem.org] (PI: Dr. Jim Williams).

FELLOWSHIPS & AWARDS

Awards

2022 American Educational Research Association Out-of-School Time SIG Emerging Scholar Award

Fellowships

2019 GWU Summer Pre-Dissertation Fellowship Award Recipient

2017-2020 Doctoral Program Fellowship (Full tuition and graduate assistant stipend)

TEACHING

*Newly developed course

University of Virginia, Charlottesville, VA

2025 Instructor of record: Foundations of Community Engagement
2025 Instructor of record: Race and Identity in Youth Development
2025 Instructor of record: Youth and Social Innovation Undergraduate Capstone

2024 Instructor of record: Foundations of Community Engagement
2024 Instructor of record: Race and Identity in Youth Development

2024 Instructor of record: Youth and Social Innovation Undergraduate Capstone

2023 Instructor of record: Foundations of Community Engagement
2023 Co-Instructor: Introduction to Youth and Social Innovation
2023 Co-Instructor: Youth and Social Innovation Undergraduate Capstone

The George Washington University, Washington, D.C.

2022 Instructor of record: Fundamentals of Feminist Theory (graduate course)
2022 Instructor of record: Introduction to Women's, Gender, and Sexuality Studies (undergraduate course)
2022 Instructor of record: Perspectives on Gender, Justice, and Equity in International Education (graduate course)*
2022 Instructor of record: MA Capstone in International Education (graduate course)
2021 Instructor of record: MA Capstone in International Education (graduate course)
2021 Instructor of record: Fundamentals of Feminist Theory (graduate course)
2021 Instructor of record: Black Feminist Theory – Writing for Social Justice (undergraduate honors course)*
2020 Teaching assistant: Critical Methodologies (doctoral level course)
2020 Teaching assistant: Development & Diversity (graduate course)
2020 Teaching assistant: Introduction to Higher Education Administration (graduate course)
2020 Teaching assistant: Introduction to Africana Studies (undergraduate course)

Invited Guest Lectures (classes):

2022 Comparative and International Education (graduate course)
2021 Globalization, Citizenship, and Education (graduate course)
2021 Education for Those Out of School (graduate course)
2019 Introduction to Curriculum Theory (graduate course)

University of Maryland Global Campus, Largo, MD

2018-2020 Instructor of record: Advanced Business Writing
2017-2018 Instructor of record: Advanced Technical Writing

Howard University, Washington, D.C.

2013 Instructor of record: Composition I (emphasis on African/African American literature)
2014 Instructor of record: Composition II (emphasis on Writing Arguments and Research Papers)
2014 Instructor of record: Composition I & II

SERVICE

2025-Present Chair, Out of School Time SIG, AERA
2024 Preliminary Examination Committee Member for Tiffany Meadows, doctoral student
2024 Reviewer, *The Urban Review*
2024 Reviewer, *Journal of African American Women and Girls*

2024-Present	Student Advising Lead, Youth and Social Innovation Program, School of Education and Human Development, University of Virginia
2024-Present	Curriculum and Program Review Committee, School of Education and Human Development, University of Virginia
2023-2025	Communications Co-Chair, Out of School Time SIG, AERA
2022	Proposal Reviewer, American Educational Research Association
2022	Faculty Co-Lead, Washington Consortium for Comparative and International Education Student Conference
2020-Present	Co-chair, UJIMA mentoring program, Critical Race Studies in Education Association
2020-2021	Interim Chair, Graduate Student Caucus, National Women's Studies Association
2019-2021	Student Representative, Graduate School of Education Doctoral Studies Committee
2019-2021	Member, Graduate School of Education Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion Committee

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

The American Educational Research Association
National Women's Studies Association
Critical Race Studies in Education Association

TRAINING & EDUCATION

Theory/Content:
Gender Politics in Africa; African Gender Theory; Black Feminism in Education; Foundations of Education; Foundations of Curriculum Theory; Curriculum Development in the Humanities.

Qualitative Methods:
Qualitative Research; Qualitative Data Collection; Qualitative Research Design & Data Analysis/Digital Epistemologies (independent study); Critical Methodologies; Ethnographic Research.

Quantitative Methods:
Group Comparison Design & Analysis; Survey Research Methods; Predictive Analysis/Regression.

Software: MAXQDA; NVIVO; SPSS

OTHER PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

2022-Present	**Reading is Fundamental**, Middle School Literacy Advisory Board Member
2016-2022	**The Pyramid Project,** Co-Founder & Program Coordinator Academic/career mentorship for underserved youth from the Mississippi Delta.
2019-2021	**INKPEN,** Founding Board Member

Programmatic guidance to organization providing school and community literary workshops and access to books by writers of color.

2012-2017 **Obama Administration**
White House Liaison, National Endowment for the Humanities, | 2016 – 2017
Special Assistant to the U.S. Attorney General, U.S. Dept. of Justice, | 2014 – 2016
National Advance Team, White House Advance & Obama for America | 2012 – 2016